

CEREAL

ALONG WITH A COMPLETE BREAKFAST, PROVIDES ESSENTIAL VITAMINS, MINERALS AND SHORT STORIES!

WHO IS ALIVE?

Cipher them language patterns, monkey-boy! There is nothing in this conversation. The air was a myth:

**PROSE BY
JAMES SETI**

Sabella, inside the fuselage, came to light a cigarette, slipped fitfully into his mind, unable to cope, and went down stunned.

He attempted to take small breaths. He had fought alongside their death-ray blasters, flaming brands that he thought in terms of sensuality, the concussion the equivalent of a shrug. He forced himself to breathe out explosively rather than breathe in fire.

The child whose death had walked out of the tunnel and into the flashing lights of the MGM Grand Casino. A hingespring-fired needle in every

direction. Police action psychotropics slapped to the wizend dimensions to reassemble the VHF radio.

Twisted wreckage eat the flesh of the dead of a volunteer skeleton crew needing effective killpower. So they seed the ground with salt.

He would probably deserve these developements:

- *A whole body ache*
- *poisons secreted in the face of the enemy*
- *an attack of diarrhea*
- *multiple hells*
- *peace and tranquility.*

Diabla on a hate-rant

by Marisa Brandt

I've got a failure on my tongue
so big I'm going to start renting it out
for birthdays, weddings and bar mitzvahs.

hey hey, Babydoll,
it's practically pure magic.

And if you want to know the truth,
I'm Satan's right hand dog.

And if you want to hear the sad, sorry truth of the matter,
I eat shit and like it.

And if you can't take the heat,
I've got a blazing inferno grilling up nice for you.

I pour hydrochloric acid on the funeral bouquet flowers
because I know what "useless" means
and it is the answer to all the Why's

when I get up on that department store Clinique counter
and crucify myself on the lipstick display.

See, I saw the Messiah approaching
from across the hill to heaven
and signaled that civilization was back the
other way.

That is the size of my evil apathy.

This is what you get to know me.

hey hey, Babydoll,
ever seen a failure like that?

You ever seen a failure like that?

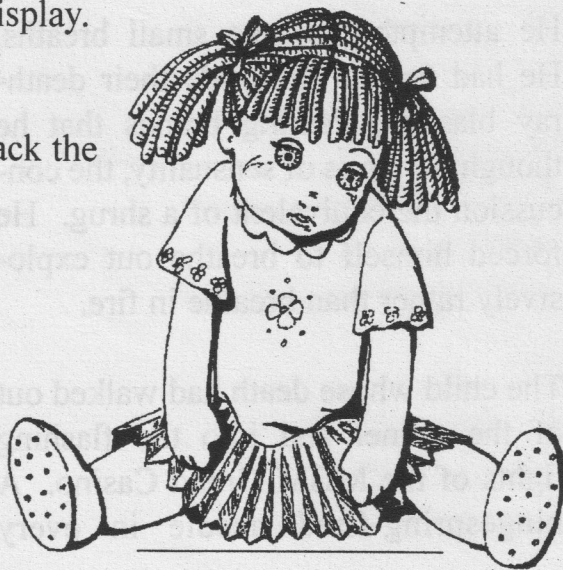


Illustration by Marisa Brandt

Panic & Revulsion in WASHINGTON D.C.

Part VIII - Bakin' Scare of Dizz'ness

Almost everything in this entire series is true. As the story progresses, I will let you, the reader, in on the things that didn't actually happen. To recap the story, visit the Cereal Website at <http://www.hellskitchen.org/cereal>

We were traveling northeast and came across the White House. There were a couple dozen protesters picketing for a couple dozen different causes: abortion, AIDS research, atomic power, arms reduction, gay rights, impeachment, Tibet, and something scrawled about Satan, I don't know if that one protester was pro or con.

It was the normal riff-raff, symbolic more than anything, gnats to highly trained security measures. The parameter was safe. After a brief sweep by Secret Service of the front garden, a professionally dressed woman in her mid-twenties came out with Buddy, the Clinton's family dog.

Jason, thinking about the night before, ran up to the gate and pleaded at the top of his lungs, "Chelsea! Chelsea! I need a place to stay! You won't know I'm there! I'll sleep under your bed!"

She turned around and walked back inside.

"CHELSEA!"

"That isn't Chelsea, man."

"Yeah, it is."

"Maybe, whatever. She's gone now, and we need to go back for the conference."

He turned toward the fence screaming, "Chelsea! CHELSEA!"

Written by
**BRIAN
BARRETT**

Sheer coincidence allowed us to find my car. It had a parking ticket, but other than that, and the metal chassis slowly melting to the street and down into storm drains,

it was unchanged. We got the rest of the money out of the glove compartment and split it up between the two of us. Life in the Capitol Sucks with a capital 'S' without the capital '\$.'

Istrode as Jason hobbled to the Mott House. He was yelling something about walking on a bloody stump and shooting pain and raw flesh being worn to bone, but nothing about the blood-thirsty penguins mocking him behind his back. At least he wasn't coughing anymore.

We arrived twenty minutes late. The conference was less than I had expected; four people around a small table. One left before we were properly introduced. The remainder were Beth

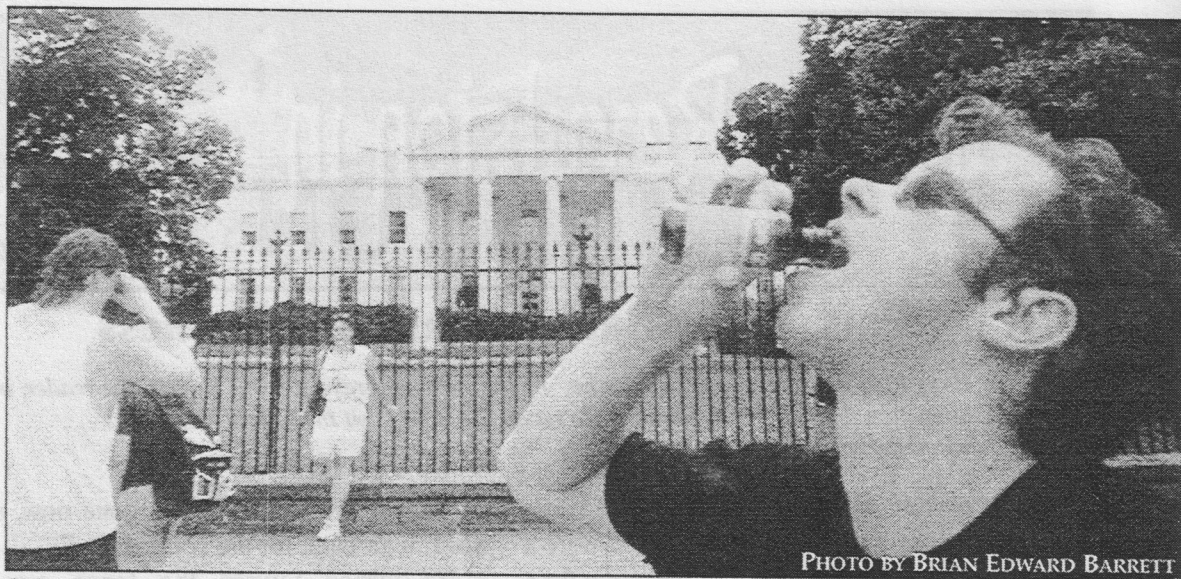


PHOTO BY BRIAN EDWARD BARRETT

Schumaker, IPA Chairperson, A woman from Youth Today, a youth worker magazine, and a guy wearing a yellow t-shirt with a picture of George Bush on it was from Covert Action Quarterly, a magazine that exposes governmental conspiracies. It's the same magazine that exposed the CIA's involvement with Rochester Institute of Technology. The shirt said something funny, but I can't remember what. The funny thing probably was that T-shirts rarely talk.

It was very informal. We introduced ourselves and our publications, discussed our current problems and possible solutions. We took care of business. I even had my mini-tape recorder to take notes, and it was silently whirring away as they asked me about the magazine. The cassette is the only proof to myself that I was actually there.

"Hell's Kitchen?" I fumbled through my mind for the explanation I had rehearsed a thousand times and pulled out what I could handle, "It's a weekly satirical magazine devoted to end of the world prophecies, political incorrectness, wacky religions, irresponsible journalism, a good porn

movie and chess.

They laughed a little and then looked at Jason for what he could add, but since he never was on the staff of Hell's Kitchen, maybe just read it once, he didn't have anything to say about the publication.

However, this did not stop him from giving a speech. Jason stood up and unnecessarily tried to clear his throat. "I've done this for four for - six - five - four yeehee - six years in school. No one knew the scope! until... it was... TOO LATE! Listen to me. No, listen to me. No, listen! Listen to me! LISTEN! TESTING! Testing...yeah...and we had...Five flyers... the fifth one... did much better... Than ALL THE REST! Brothel na ross center submitters under the guise of my drool for twelve years! And SIX DOLLARS! They ate from my hand like Boasts -- I mean -- ghosts! gn' gn' gn' gn'... Goats! Ghost goats! Like those ghost goats ghost-goats... with big fucking teeth! And... fangs! And heads like I clobbered-them-good-in-the-face-with-a-bending-thing-that-I-found... RIGHT HERE! And no one could stop me! Not

even you or you or the porjeft flight fit simians
and core... pistol jug moranmal... lact... astify...
akni... er... low... ga... ga... ga... gaa... ...
gaaaaaahhhh..."

He slowly sat back down, continuing to make
quiet, incoherent noises for the next fifteen min-
utes as the meeting proceeded.

About thirty glassy minutes later it was over.
The CAQ guy asked us if we needed a ride some-
where. He was adamant about it.

"Sure," Then I queried, "Do you know where
there is something like a sidewalk cafe where we
can sit and watch everything go by?"

"No problem. Get in." He opened the door to
his hunter-green Ford Explorer.

I was amazed by how close he was able to park
to the conference, about fifteen feet from the
entrance. This was obviously a set-up.

It was no more than a two minute ride -- about
a block and a half. He pointed out a couple land-
marks, Supreme Court Building and the National
Headquarters of the Nazi Party, before dropping
us off in front of a cafe next to a pub called the
Capitol Bar.

We walked up to the bar and opened the door.
The moment we crossed the threshold was like
entering a different world where secrets are
revealed and you are told 'memory is unimpor-
tant.'

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**TO BE CONTINUED IN NEXT
CEREAL:**

**Panic & Revulsion in
WASHINGTON D.C.**

-Part 9-

**A SOFT TICKET TO THAT NAKED
EXPLODING MACHINE JUNKIE
LUNCH? HOW QUEER!**

WORDS

BY JASON PAUL FOX

You're likely to say words are what they say;
they say what you're likely to say,
you like to say what they're likely to say.
My words don't say what they say,
my words say what they don't say.
What my words say they don't say
what they don't say, my words say.
My words don't say what you like to say,
my words don't like what you say.
When they don't say what I say,
you say my words say what you say—
while I say my words don't say what they say.
They say what they don't say.
When you want to say what words say
you say what you want to say in words—
you want to say what words say your way.
When I want to say what words say,
I *do* what you say words say to say
what words that don't say your way say
in words that don't say what they say—
that say what they don't say.
(My words don't say what they say.
They say what they don't say.)

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**Got any words?
Cereal@hellskitchen.org**

Peggy Sue: ASSASSIN PART I - FIRST IMPRESSIONS

She stepped into the lunchroom, her high-heeled leather boots clicking on the tiled floor, the scent of cigarette smoke still hanging in the air around her. A few students dared look up as she entered but none dared look at her. She knew they were afraid and liked it that way. With a flick of her bikers jacket she moved toward her usually empty table but stopped at a hand on her shoulder. Slowly she turned and smiled thinly at the man behind her. He met her gaze calmly, his albino skin, obsidian hair, and the dark circles under his red eyes lending him a daemonic air.

"That's mine." He whispered, stepping past her to settle into the chair in the far corner.

She rolled her eyes and walked over to sit at one of the empty seats surrounding the table.

"Do not."

She spun about and grabbed the front of his shirt, pulling him across the table towards her, "Listen, butthead, I don't take this kinda shit from nobody. So just fuck off."

He slid back into his seat as she released him and nodded, "Then

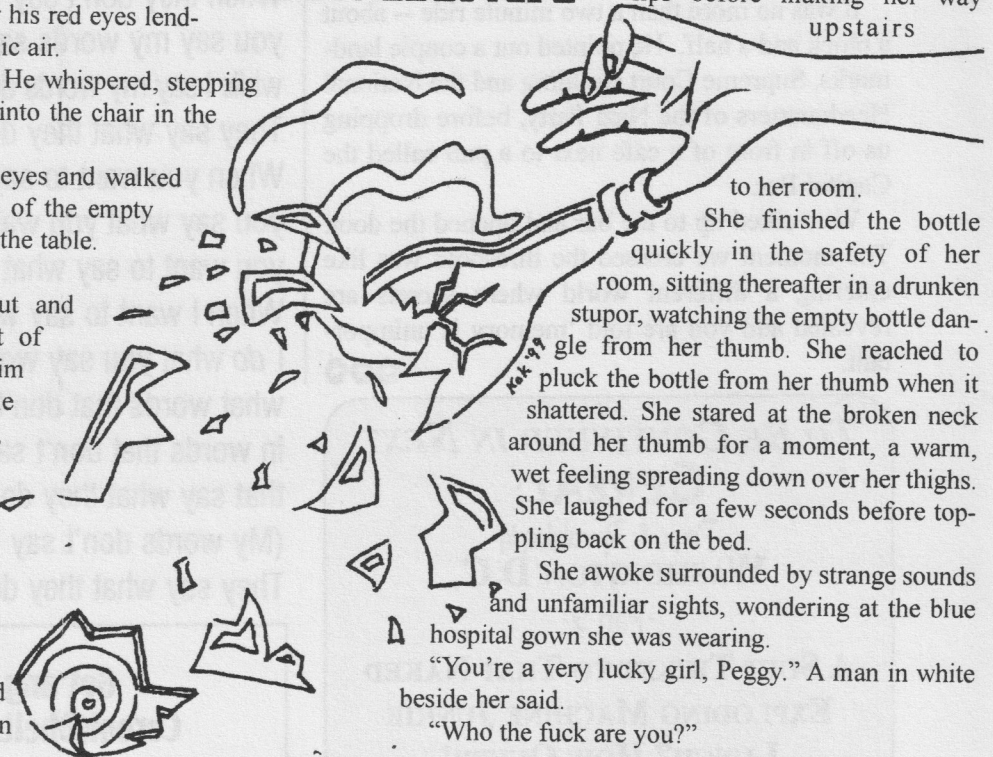
leave."

She held his gaze for a few seconds before losing her nerve in the face of his unshakable calm and quickly fleeing the lunchroom again.

She slid the key into the lock of the glass and brass cabinet left to her mother when her grandfather passed away. She raised the half empty bottle of Jack Daniels toward the ceiling.

"Here's to you, gramps." She laughed, tipping the bottle to her lips before making her way upstairs

Written by
**KYLE
MAWHINEY**



to her room.

She finished the bottle quickly in the safety of her room, sitting thereafter in a drunken stupor, watching the empty bottle dangle from her thumb. She reached to pluck the bottle from her thumb when it shattered. She stared at the broken neck around her thumb for a moment, a warm, wet feeling spreading down over her thighs. She laughed for a few seconds before toppling back on the bed.

She awoke surrounded by strange sounds and unfamiliar sights, wondering at the blue hospital gown she was wearing.

"You're a very lucky girl, Peggy." A man in white beside her said.

"Who the fuck are you?"

"Peggy! That's no way to talk to the doctor!"

She looked over at her mother and rolled her eyes. The red around her eyes made it clear she'd been crying. "What the hell is going on?"

"Peggy!"

"It's all right, Mrs. Rourschach. Your daughter has had a very traumatic experience."

"What the fuck is going on?!"

"You've been shot." The doctor explained, "There was no serious damage. The bullet passed through you without hitting anything vital. Your mother has already informed the police. You'll be back in school in a few days."

Peggy stepped into the lunchroom a week later, showing off the bullet hole in her jacket. She crossed the room with sure steps and sat herself pointedly across from the albino, flipping out her jacket before settling down to let him see the hole in the back of her jacket.

"There's no need to show that to me. You were drunk when you were shot, and where the shell hit was in no way lethal." He whispered.

"How did you know I was drunk?" she demanded, grabbing his shirt front again.

"I shot you. I purposefully waited until you were drunk, then placed a two twenty-eight caliber, armor piercing round through the soft flesh below your ribs. The alcohol in your system saved you from possibly fatal shock and you simply passed out. But you real-

ly shouldn't drink. It doesn't suit you."

"You shot me!" she swallowed, "Why?"

"You defied me."

"You tried to kill me just because I sat at your fucking table?!"

"I did not try to kill you. I'm much too good a shot. If I had been trying to kill you, first of all I wouldn't have used an armor piercing round, and secondly they'd still be scraping you off the wall." He watched her calmly for a moment, "You know, that jacket doesn't do anything for you."

"You're sick!" she whispered, fighting back frightened tears.

He pulled a white silk handkerchief from his pocket and offered it to her before settling back and taking a slow breath, "It's my way. I am sorry for shooting you though. I never realized quite how beautiful a lady you are."

"Why do you keep saying that? You shot me!"

"And I said I was wrong for it. You are a beautiful woman. You should stop wearing the leathers and heels, they make you look whorish." He reached over and pulled the cigarettes and lighter from her pocket as he continued, "These and the drinking don't help either. They may make you look tough, but you're no stronger than anyone else."

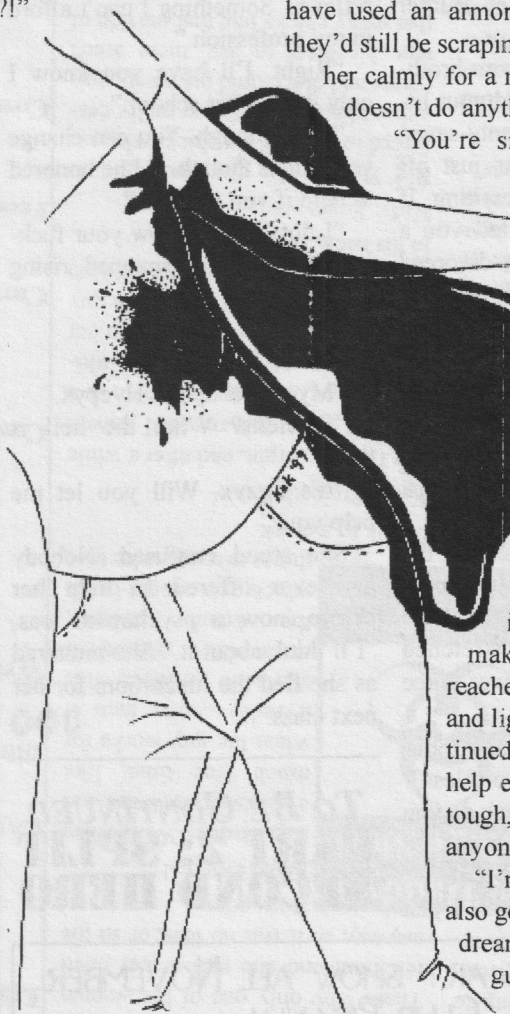
"I'm tougher than you any day. I also got it tougher than you could ever dream of. So just take your fucking guns and shove them up your ass!"

"How tough have you got it?"

"I don't have to tell you shit."

"I just thought you might want to talk about it."

Peggy reached to grab her lighter and cigarettes



then slapped them away and turned around, "You want tough? Listen to this: My father is in Tennessee shackled up with some tramp. My mother is always off working overtime, leaving me to take care of my brother with the little money I make at Burger King."

"You don't support your brother with your money. And your little income is about twenty-seven thousand dollars a year just off your forays into erotic writing. If you want tough I can tell you a story. My parents were divorced when I was three. My mother moved to Alaska and remarried. My father died in Panama during the Noriega deal. Somehow I got lost in the shuffle. Since then I've been working my butt off trying to find a job. My last one was back in eighty-eight, a corporate exec. I thought I was set for life with the cash I made on that kill. It's amazing how relatively worthless two million is when it's stretched between four people over three years."

"A hundred and seventy thousand bucks per year is worthless?! To who? And who the fuck do you think I am that I'm going to believe a load of shit like that?"

"Believe what you will. I just

exist," he shrugged, "You're also very bright."

"Fuck you. That's why I'm failing all my classes."

"You're failing because you're constantly drunk. I can't stand alcohol personally, it dulls the reflexes. Something I can't afford in my profession."

"Right. I'll have you know I only drink after school."

"True enough. You can change your status though. I'd be honored to help if you want to."

"I don't even know your fucking name." Peggy snapped, rising to leave.

"Syzyx."

"What?"

"My name. Syzyx Hyepyx."

"Sizeicks? What the hell is that?"

"It's Syzyx. Will you let me help you?"

She stood confused. Nobody had ever offered to help her before, now a psychopath was, "I'll think about it." She muttered as she fled the lunchroom for her next class.



TO BE CONTINUED PART 2: SPLIT SECOND HERO

THARY KOK'S ART SHOW ALL NOVEMBER
AT CLUB PIRANHA
THARYART@HOTMAIL.COM

House of Hellfira: A Rochester Community
WWW.ONELIST.COM/COMMUNITIES/HELLFIRA

CEREAL

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